



Southern states

with the American South are uniquely characterful and romantic. Carrying a huge historical legacy from the days of plantations, slavery, and the Civil War, this region is also home to such quintessentially modern phenomena as the oil industry and jazz music.

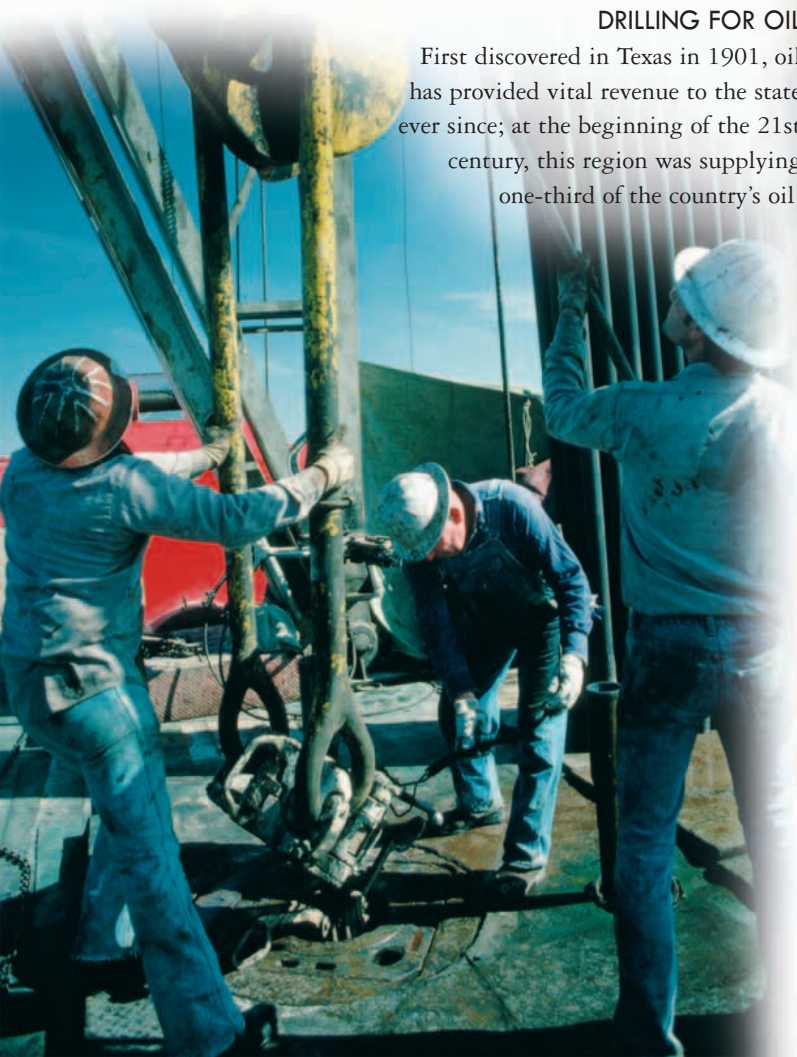


LAND OF COTTON

The US is the world's leading producer of cotton. Most of this yield is grown in the South, where Spanish colonists introduced the first cotton plants. Originally, cotton was picked by hand, but today the job is done mechanically. In cotton country, the fluffy harvest is known as "white gold."

DRILLING FOR OIL

First discovered in Texas in 1901, oil has provided vital revenue to the state ever since; at the beginning of the 21st century, this region was supplying one-third of the country's oil.



Children in New Orleans make music in the street.



HORSE RACING IN KENTUCKY

The celebrated Kentucky Derby was first held in 1875. Each year, thousands of enthusiasts fill the main spectator area (the infield) shown here; wealthy patrons use the grandstand. The event's success inspired the local breeding of thoroughbreds for which the state is now famous.